ETCSL 5.6.3 — The farmer's instructions

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- **Editors:** ETCSL project (J. Black, G. Cunningham, E. Robson, G. Zólyomi et al.), Oxford 1998–2006 (see the XML header for the composite's sources).
- **URLs:** transliteration https://etcsl.orinst.ox.ac.uk/cgi-bin/etcsl.cgi?text=c.5.6.3 ; translation https://etcsl.orinst.ox.ac.uk/cgi-bin/etcsl.cgi?text=t.5.6.3
- **Retrieved:** 2026-10-21, copied from the local OTA 2518 bulk corpus (`../_bulk/etcsl.zip`, members `etcsl/transliterations/c.5.6.3.xml`, `etcsl/translations/t.5.6.3.xml`). The XML is authoritative.
- **Licence:** CC BY-NC-SA 3.0 (OTA deposit); © ETCSL project, University of Oxford. Committed.

Content

An old farmer (ETCSL: "Ud-ul-uru") instructs his son through the agricultural year: preparing and irrigating the field (2–22), the plough-teams and ploughing (23–45), sowing (46–63), the rites against vermin and the watering of the growing barley (64–73), the harvest (74–90), threshing, winnowing and measuring (91–109); 110–111: "the instructions of Ninurta, son of Enlil; Ninurta, faithful farmer of Enlil, your praise is good".

Files

- `c.5.6.3.xml`, `t.5.6.3.xml` — ETCSL TEI source (lemmatised `<w form lemma pos label>`).
- `transliteration.md` (111 composite lines (1–111)), `translation.md` — conversions by `../../../tools/etcsl2md.py`.

Line numbering

ETCSL composite numbering; the project files use ETCSL's labels.

Lemmas and morphology

ORACC `epsd2-literary--Q000784--Farmers-Instructions/` (lemma + morph for every word).

Modern editions not used (recorded)

Civil 1994, *The Farmer's Instructions: A Sumerian Agricultural Manual* (AuOr Suppl. 5; the standard edition, with score): not obtained (records only: no purchase).

Usefulness

Base text (rank 1) for `סיפורי-הבריאה-המסופוטמיים/5-הוראות-האיכר/`. ETCSL's prose translation is rank 3 (check only, after drafting).